

Follow-along pack

The 4 Levels of Claude Cowork.

A real, copy-paste prompt for each level. Start at Level 1 and climb — each one builds on the last.

WRITTEN BY

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FORMAT

Copy → paste → run

READ TIME

4 minutes

Level 1 • Foundation

A folder Claude works in, and a note that tells it how you like things done.

STEP 1

Teach Claude who you are

A quick interview Claude turns into a CLAUDE.md file — its memory of you. Do this once and every future task follows your rules without re-explaining yourself.

PROMPT

I want you to get to know me so you can work the way I like. Ask me 7 quick questions, one at a time, about who I am, what I do, who I do it for, and how I like things written and organized. Wait for each answer before asking the next. When we're done, write a CLAUDE.md file in this folder that sums it all up.

STEP 2

Clean up a messy folder

Point Claude at a real, messy folder — your Downloads or Desktop — and watch it actually work inside your files instead of just chatting.

PROMPT

Look at every file in this folder and tell me what's in here in plain English. Then suggest a simple way to sort everything into clearly named subfolders. Show me your plan first and wait for my okay before you move or rename anything.

Level 2 · Skills (Workflows)

Teach Claude a job once, then run it with a single word.

STEP 1

Build a summarize-and-do skill

Turns any long thing into a short summary with a clear to-do list. No connector needed, so anyone can build this today.

PROMPT

Build me a reusable skill called "Quick Brief." When I give it any long document, transcript, or messy notes, it should return three things: a two-sentence summary, the 5 key points as a short list, and a clear list of action items with who they're for. Save the skill with the trigger phrases "quick brief," "summarize this," and "break this down."

STEP 2

Pull your day together from your apps

The moment a skill stops living in a box and starts touching your real day.

PROMPT

Look at my calendar for today and my email from the last two days. Give me a short, plain-English rundown: what meetings I have and anything I should prep for, plus which emails still need a reply. Put the most urgent things first and keep it to one screen.

STEP 3

Build a skill that writes in your voice

Claude reads your real emails, learns how you write, and saves it as a reusable skill — your drafts sound like you from now on. Uses your email connector.

PROMPT

Read my last 20 sent emails in Gmail. Study my tone, greetings, sign-offs, sentence rhythm, and phrases I use often. Then build a reusable skill that drafts replies in that exact voice — always showing me the draft to review, never sending on its own.

Level 3 · Scheduled Tasks (Automations)

Work that runs itself on a schedule, even while you sleep.

STEP 1

Wake up to a morning briefing

Runs on its own every morning — you stop hunting for what happened and start the day already caught up.

PROMPT

Every morning at 7am, search the web for the most important news in [your field/industry]. Pick the 5 stories that matter most, summarize each in two plain-English sentences, and save it as a dated note in this folder called "Morning Briefing [date]."

Level 4 · Live Artifacts (Cowork OS)

Claude builds you a little app that keeps updating itself.

STEP 1

Build your Cowork OS Dashboard

Not a screenshot — a living view. It pulls the latest from your apps every time you open it.

PROMPT

Build me a live dashboard I can open every morning, call it my Cowork OS Dashboard. Pull from my email and calendar and show today's meetings, anything I need to prep for, and which emails still need a reply. Put the most urgent things at the top and give it a clean, calm look.

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

Copy the prompt, paste it into Cowork, hit go. Work top to bottom — each level builds on the one before it, so don't skip. Anything in [brackets] is a blank to fill in with your own words.